Junehyoung Jeon

junehyoungjeon@utexas.edu

Research Interests

I am interested in how the early Universe and its components such as galaxies and black holes evolved. I approach these problems creating/using theoretical models and hydrodynamical simulations to study early structure formation.

Education

Doctor of Philosophy in Astronomy Expected completion 2026
Astronomy Department, University of Texas at Austin, Austin, Texas

Master of Arts in Astronomy August 2023
Astronomy Department, University of Texas at Austin, Austin, Texas

Bachelor of Science in Astrophysics, Minor in Physics May 2021
Barrett Honors College, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona
Average unweighted GPA: 4.0/4.0

Publications

Gupta, A. et al. (**Incl. Jeon**) (2026). *A Rapid Evolution in the Observed $M_{\rm BH}/M_*$ Relation at $z > 3$ Revealed via Spectro-photometric SED-Modeling* .
arxiv: Submitted to ApJ.

Fei, Q. et al. (**Incl. Jeon**) (2026). *A GLIMPSE of Intermediate Mass Black holes in the epoch of reionization: Witnessing the Descendants of Direct Collapse?*.
The Astrophysical Journal, Volume **1003**, Issue 2, 244.

Jeon, J. et al. (2026). *What is Powering the Enigmatic He* II *Emitter Hebe: The First Stars or Black Holes?*.
arXiv:2605.30414, Submitted to ApJ.

Jeon, J. et al. (2026). *Hunting for the First Explosions at the High-Redshift Frontier*.
The Astrophysical Journal, Volume **1001**, Issue 1, 3.

Jeon, J. et al. (2026). *Little Red Dots and their Progenitors from Direct Collapse Black Holes*.
The Astrophysical Journal, Volume **998**, Issue 1, 148.

Jeon, J. et al. (2025). *The Emerging Black Hole Mass Function in the High-Redshift Universe*.
The Astrophysical Journal, Volume **988**, Issue 1, 110.

Zhang, S., Liu, B., Bromm, V., **Jeon, J.**, et al. (2025). *How do Massive Primordial Black Holes Impact the Formation of the First Stars and Galaxies?*.
The Astrophysical Journal, Volume **987**, Issue 2, 185.

Taylor, A., Finkelstein, S., Kocevski, D., **Jeon, J.**, et al. (2025). *Broad-Line AGN at* $3.5 < z < 6$*: The Black Hole Mass Function and a Connection with Little Red Dots* .
The Astrophysical Journal, Volume **986**, Issue 2, 165.

Jeon, J. et al. (2025). *Physical Pathways for JWST-Observed Supermassive Black Holes in the Early Universe.*
The Astrophysical Journal, Volume **979**, Issue 2, 127.

Jeon, J. et al. (2023). *Observability of Low-Luminosity AGN in the Early Universe with JWST.*
Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, **524**, 176-187

Jeon, J. et al. (2022). *Maximal X-ray feedback in the pre-reionization Universe.*
Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, **515**, 5568-5575

Conference Talks and Presentations

Hunting for the First Explosions at the High-Redshift Frontier
Spring Symposium, Space Telescope Science Institute May 2026

Little Red Dots and their Progenitors from Direct Collapse Black Holes
ITC Lunch, Harvard Center for Astrophysics September 2025

Formation and Evolution of Supermassive Black Holes in the Early Universe
Galaxy Formation Seminar, Center for Computational Astrophysics October 2025
Seminar, Columbia University Astronomy & Astrophysics October 2025
MAT talks, MIT Kavli Institute September 2025
HEAD Seminar, Harvard Center for Astrophysics September 2025
Galaxy and AGN Journal Club, Space Telescope Science Institute September 2025

The Emerging Black Hole Mass Function in the High-Redshift Universe
Cosmic Frontier Center Inaugural Conference, Austin, United States May 2025

Physical Pathways for JWST-Observed Supermassive Black Holes in the Early Universe
CRISOL25, Toledo, Spain (remote) May 2025
Probing the Genesis of SMBH, Kashiwa, Japan (remote) November 2024
CCA-CFC Workshop, Austin, United States November 2024
ITC Lunch, Harvard Center for Astrophysics November 2024

Conditions for Efficient Growth of Supermassive Black Holes in the Early Universe
COSPAR 2024, Busan, South Korea July 2024
Massive Black Holes in the First Billion Years, Kinsale, Ireland April 2024

Observability of Low-Luminosity AGN in the Early Universe with JWST.
Black Holes on Broadway, New York City, United States December 2023
Young Astronomers on Galactic Nuclei, Palermo, Italy October 2023

Awards and Honors

College Continuing Graduate Fellowship, UT Austin ($10,000) 2026
David Alan Benfield Memorial Fellowship in Astronomy, UT Austin ($1,500) 2025
Graduate School Dissertation Writing Fellowship, UT Austin ($24,000) 2025
Graduate Summer Excellence Award, UT Austin ($10,000) 2025
Board of Visitors Graduate Student Endowment Fund ($10,000), UT Austin 2023
Professional Development Award, UT Austin ($500) 2023
The College of Liberal Arts and Sciences Dean's Medal, ASU 2021
Moeur Award, ASU Alumni Association 2021
New American University Award ($5,000) 2018-2021
The College of Liberal Arts and Sciences Dean's List, ASU 2018-2021

Teaching and Mentoring

Undergraduate Research Projects, University of Texas at Austin Fall 2024 - Current

- Mentored undergraduate students on research projects on the first supermassive black holes, enabling the students to perform theoretical modeling and and analysis.
- Guided the students in writing research publications and conference presentations, producing concrete results from the students' work.

Mentor, Undergraduate Mentorship in Astronomy Program, University of Texas at Austin Fall 2023 - Current

- Advised multiple undergraduate mentees on various topics, including research, graduate school preparation, and applications, helping them advance their academic career.
- Held weekly meetings to discuss updates and new questions brought up by the mentees, guiding them in general academics.

Teaching Assistant, University of Texas at Austin: Astrophysics Spring 2025

- Assisted astronomy and physics major upper class students with assignments and projects, helping their understanding of the lecture concepts

and applications.
- Prepared and taught introductory python modules designed for students who have no prior experience, introducing them to the basics of coding in astrophysics.

Teaching Assistant, University of Texas at Austin: Practical Introduction to Research — Spring 2024, Fall 2021

- Guided astronomy and physics major students through in-class activities such as coding, writing resume, and making posters, providing them with introductory skills in academia.
- Prepared coding and lecture modules for the students, leading the students to understand the concepts.

Teaching Assistant, University of Texas at Austin: Cosmology — Fall 2022

- Explained course topics to students after class, helping them individually to grasp lecture concepts that they might not have fully understood.
- Guided students through their homeworks, assisting them in understanding questions and steps to solve various cosmology problems.

Tutor, Arizona State University School of Earth and Space Exploration: Introduction to Astrophysics and Cosmology II — Spring 2021

- Participated in the live classes to answer the questions students asked, aiding the instructor in the lectures
- Graded assignments with feedback, helping students better understand the problems and their mistakes
- Created visual figures that demonstrated important topics in cosmology, easing the students' understanding of the topics

Learning Assistant, Arizona State University Physics Department: Science of Musical Instruments, University Physics I Mechanics, University Physics II Electricity and Magnetism — Fall 2019 - Spring 2021

- Participated in three physics courses as a sub-instructor
- Aided students during in-class problems, activities and questions regarding homework or exam problems

Skills

Programming: Python, C, Fortran, High Performance Computing
Operating systems: Windows, Linux
Software: LaTeX, Mathematica
Languages: English, Korean